

Question 43 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Explain on-the-job and off-the-job training methods with suitable examples.

Answer

Training methods are broadly on-the-job (learning in the actual work setting) and off-the-job (learning away from daily work). Each suits different objectives.

- 1. On-the-job training (OJT):** Learning while performing real work under guidance.
- 2. Examples of OJT:** Coaching by supervisor, job rotation, apprenticeship, understudy, internships, action learning projects.
- 3. Advantages of OJT:** High relevance, lower extra cost, easier transfer, real equipment and customers.
- 4. Limitations of OJT:** Quality depends on the boss; production pressure; possible learning of bad habits; safety risks.
- 5. Off-the-job training:** Learning away from the workstation in classroom, workshop or external institute.
- 6. Examples:** Lectures, case study, role play, vestibule training, simulations, sensitivity training, conferences, MBA-type courses.
- 7. Advantages:** Focused attention, safer practice, expert faculty, conceptual depth, mixing with other participants.
- 8. Limitations:** Transfer problems, higher cost, possible irrelevance if not designed from TNA. A complete HRD approach often blends both.

Conclusion. *On-the-job methods excel for practical skills; off-the-job methods excel for concepts and safe practice. Choice should follow objectives.*